

APPLICATION
OF THE
ZERO TRUST FRAMEWORK
IN
U.S. PUBLIC AND PRIVATE SECTORS:
ADDRESSING
INCONSISTENT IMPLEMENTATION

Issues in Global Cybersecurity Policy

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December 7, 2025

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To: U.S Public and Private Sectors

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Date: December 7, 2025

Subject: Addressing Inconsistent Implementation of the Zero Trust Framework

I. Introduction

Over the past few decades, rapid technological advancement has transformed how societies operate in sectors such as healthcare, the economy, and public safety. These developments have introduced countless benefits, tools, and innovative capabilities, but they have also generated new threats, vulnerabilities, and risks. Cyberattacks are now evolving at unprecedented speed, employing increasingly sophisticated tactics that can disrupt economic activity, erode public trust, and even compromise national security.

Following several high-profile cybersecurity incidents in the United States, the need for more resilient security models has become a national priority. As noted in Juniper Networks' white paper "*The Rise of Zero Trust*", perimeter-based network strategies are unable to protect information and resources. The expansion of cloud workloads, widespread use of unmanaged and mobile devices, and increased adversary lateral movement have rendered traditional perimeter defenses ineffective. In response, the "*Zero Trust (ZT) Framework*", a model built on continuous authentication, authorization, and validation, has emerged as one of the most effective approaches for mitigating modern cyber risks.

Despite significant adoption across state and non-state agencies, the implementation of ZT remains uneven. Many organizations face technical, operational, and governance barriers that result in partial or inconsistent application of their principles. These irregularities create gaps in security posture and undermine the overall stability and effectiveness of national cybersecurity efforts.

This policy memo analyzes the current state of ZT framework implementation in the U.S. public and private sectors, examines the underlying causes of inconsistent adoption, and provides actionable policy recommendations to address these challenges and strengthen national cyber resilience.

II. Problem Statement: Inconsistent Zero Trust Framework Implementation

Although many federal agencies, state and local governments, and private sector organizations have made significant efforts to implement ZT, the adoption of the model remains far from complete. As highlighted by cybersecurity engineer Niranjan Shankar of “*InfoSecurity Magazine*”, former Acting Federal CISO Mike Duffy noted that all entities still require more mature and defensible ZT architectures¹. However, this progress has not been hindered by persistent obstacles throughout the adoption process, leading to inconsistent implementation and preventing U.S. systems from achieving the level of resilience and security required in today’s threat landscape, and posing ongoing challenges for national cyber readiness.

III. Definition of the Zero Trust Framework

ZT is a security approach that primarily prioritizes the protection of assets, such as devices, data, programs, and cloud components, by assuming that threats may originate from anywhere, whether inside or outside the network. Under this paradigm, no user, device, application, or service is granted implicit trust based solely on its location within the system. Instead, every access request must undergo continuous authentication, authorization, and verification. The environment requires strict monitoring and controls to reduce the risk of unauthorized lateral movement². As a result, any entity can shift from a perimeter-centric

¹ Shankar, Niranjan. 2025. “Zero Trust Must Be a Cybersecurity Priority for the Trump Government.” *Infosecurity Magazine*. February 19. <https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/opinions/zero-trust-priority-trump/>

² Fernandez, Eduardo. 2024. “A Critical Analysis of Zero Trust Architecture.” *Computer Standards & Interfaces. Science Direct*. January 13.

defense to a more dynamic, identity-driven security posture that enforces accurate least-privilege entry and evaluates availability at every stage of the workflow.

IV. Origins and Evolution of the Zero Trust Framework

According to NIST Special Publication 800-207, the foundations of the Zero Trust Architecture (ZTA) emerged from several formerly security notions³. One of the earliest influences was the Defense Information Systems Agency's (DISA) "*Black Core*" strategy, developed within the Department of Defense to protect communications and secure the transmission of confidential information across untrusted landscapes. In parallel, the "*Jericho Forum*", a global cybersecurity thought-leadership group, advanced the idea of "*de-perimeterization*", arguing that traditional network boundaries were no longer sufficient to defend current digital systems. The concept ZT was later formalized by Forrester analyst John Kindervag, whose framework significantly contributed to the development of contemporary cybersecurity policies and standards, including the Federal Information Security Modernization Act (FISMA), the Risk Management Framework (RMF), and related guidance. ZT became a practical cybersecurity philosophy.

V. Core Principles and Assumptions of the Zero Trust Framework

All integrations generally involve the following tenets⁴:

- All device classes, data sources, and computing services are treated as resources.
- All communication is untrusted until verified, regardless of whether the request originates from inside or outside the infrastructure ("*Never Trust, Always Verify*").
- Authentication and authorization for a resource does not imply access to another ("*Least-Privilege Access*").

³ Rose, Scott. 2020. "Zero Trust Architecture." NIST Special Publication 800-207. August. <https://doi.org/10.6028/NIST.SP.800-207>.

⁴ "The Rise of Zero Trust." 2019. Engineering Simplicity. Juniper Networks, Inc. December. <https://www.juniper.net/content/dam/www/assets/white-papers/us/en/security/the-rise-of-zero-trust.pdf>.

- The visibility and accessibility of resources are determined by dynamic policies that assess the client’s status, behavioral attributes, and environmental conditions.
- Continuous monitoring and revalidation are required during all sessions to maintain security while balancing usability and operational demands.

Taken together, these assumptions define ZT as a continuous, policy-driven strategy and guide entities toward a more resilient pathway that is regularly examined to limit the impact of potential breaches and reduce attack surfaces.

VI. Current Adoption of Zero Trust Framework in U.S. Public and Private Sectors

To illustrate the current landscape of ZT administration across the United States, the following cases show how the approach is being executed within cross-sector environments.

One prominent example of a public-sector ZT framework initiative is the Department of Defense's (DoD) “*Zero Trust Strategy*”, issued in 2022 by the DoD Chief Information Officer’s Portfolio Management Office⁵. The DoD determined that traditional cybersecurity defenses fail to secure mission systems, classified information, and the extensive ecosystem of internal users, external partners, and interconnected assets. In response, the department incorporated key and robust ZT pillars, such as least-privilege access, strong multifactor authentication, micro-segmentation, and advanced encryption, into its enterprise-wide network plan, “*DoD Information Network*” (*DODIN*). The “*Zero Trust Strategy*” also emphasizes governance, workforce training, and an organizational culture committed to continuous verification and operational resilience. By aligning policy and cloud-based technology, the DoD aims to reduce its attack surface, improve detection and response capabilities, and strengthen the security posture of applications, devices, and services across the joint force.

⁵ Department of Defense (DOD). 2022. “DoD Zero Trust Strategy.” Portfolio Management Office. November 7. <https://dodcio.defense.gov/Portals/0/Documents/Library/DoD-ZTStrategy.pdf>

According to the American Technology Council - Industry Advisory Council (ACT-IAC) report "*Zero Trust Cybersecurity: Current Trends*", Google's BeyondCorp is a clear example of a mature implementation of the Zero Trust framework in the private sector⁶. *BeyondCorp* aims to shift critical components, such as device inventories, policy engines, and trust repositories, away from traditional on-premises data centers toward cloud-delivered controls. Google applies these capabilities using an identity-aware proxy and related cloud services that act as centralized control points for authentication, authorization, and policy management. By migrating privilege control to the application layer and administering policies to user signals rather than network location, *BeyondCorp* represents a successful benchmark of how a comprehensive ZT architecture can reduce reliance on perimeter defenses and enable fine-grained access control.

According to the testimony of Kevin Kerr, former Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) of *Oak Ridge National Laboratory* and current principal security consultant at *Trustwave*, crucial distinctions exist between ZT applications in both the public and private sectors⁷. Drawing on his experience in both environments, Kerr highlights that adaptation varies considerably based on each organization's operational mission, threat exposure, and the criticality of the systems involved. His audit further notes that, despite these differences, ZT proves effective across contexts due to its adaptive, risk-based emphasis on data protection and collaboration between business and security teams. underscores that successful ZT integration for both areas requires precise data categorization and the deployment of advanced tools and controls, such as artificial intelligence for continuous monitoring, remote-access security solutions, and machine-learning-driven automation, to reduce complexity in hybrid and cloud networks. Through this examination, we can appreciate how

⁶ American Council for Technology. 2019. "Zero Trust Cybersecurity Current Trends." American Council for Technology-Industry Advisory Council. April 18. [https://www.actiac.org/system/files/ACT-IAC Zero Trust Project Report 04182019.pdf](https://www.actiac.org/system/files/ACT-IAC%20Zero%20Trust%20Project%20Report%2004182019.pdf)

⁷ Kerr, Kevin. 2023. "Zero Trust: Public and Private Sectors Facing Similar Risks." TW. Trustwave Holdings, Inc. August 24. <https://www.trustwave.com/en-us/resources/blogs/trustwave-blog/zero-trust-public-and-private-sectors-facing-similar-risks/>.

theoretical ZT tenets are being translated into practical, real-world implementations across multiple sectors.

VII. Causes of Inconsistent Zero Trust Framework Implementation

Recent research identifies several barriers and challenges that slow or limit ZT adoption across public and private organizations:

- **Budget Constraints:** Many organizations lack sustained funding to execute the full technical and organizational changes that ZT requires. “*Executive Order 14028*” and related guidance mandate upgrades in hardware and software, as well as training programs. Nevertheless, configuration, pilot testing, and ongoing maintenance need substantial, long-term investment. Without multi-year funding commitments, agencies and firms often implement only partial measures. Threats continue to evolve every year, making it essential to allocate prioritized resources or budgets for ZT cybersecurity to achieve effective large-scale implementation and robust cyber defenses (Harding, CSIS)⁸.
- **Operational Resistance & Cultural Friction:** Transitioning to a ZT model is not purely mechanical; it demands changes to workflows, roles, and operating procedures. Employees and federal units can resist continuous verification processes that disrupt daily routines or impose perceived friction on productivity. This issue slows rollouts and encourages superficial implementations rather than comprehensive transformation (Harding, CSIS).

⁸ Harding, Emily. 2025. ““Never Trust, Always Verify.”” Center for Strategic & International Studies (CSIS). <https://features.csis.org/zero-trust-architecture/>

- **Compatibility with Legacy Systems:** Public and private entities frequently operate legacy systems that were designed around static, perimeter-based controls. These technologies often lack modern identity, telemetry, or API hooks required for ZT enforcement. As a result, organizations may continue to accumulate obsolete systems that can increase their vulnerability to potential attacks, while also attempting to patch new rules onto incompatible components, creating hybrid environments difficult to secure uniformly (Dhiman 2024).
- **Technical Complexity:** Each entity’s mission, asset profile, and operational requirements differ, forcing ZT applications to be highly tailored. Access policies must account for trust levels, device posture, contextual signals, and mission-critical exceptions. That growing scope can introduce configuration problems, inconsistent policy execution, and an expanded attack surface than originally intended (Dhiman 2024)⁹.

Beyond operational and resource restraints, some scholars, including Dinolt (2022), argue that the ZT framework is fundamentally difficult to realize in modern environments¹⁰. Dinolt contends that ZT lacks a coherent and stable definition of “*reliability*”, resulting in conceptual ambiguity, shifting objectives, and varied interpretations across entities. Furthermore, he further points out that several core fundamentals are neither technically practical nor consistently enforceable, given that adherence is voluntary and compliance is not tied to legal or regulatory repercussions. Moreover, the approach’s reliance on continuously updated controls conflicts with established security engineering principles such as the economy of mechanism and the need for architectural stability over time. These critiques underscore that ZT conceptual inconsistencies also contribute to uneven and incomplete adoption.

⁹ Dhiman, Poonam. 2024. “A Review and Comparative Analysis of Relevant Approaches of Zero Trust Network Model.” Sensors. MDPI. February 19. <https://doi.org/10.3390/s24041328>.

¹⁰ Dinolt, George. 2022. “Can You Trust Zero Trust?” IEEE Xplore. August 2.

VIII. Policy Recommendations

Applying the ZT framework requires long-term planning and a strategic mindset capable of addressing the structural and resource challenges identified in the previous section. The following policy suggestions aim to establish maturity milestones, accelerate migration, and strengthen the consistency and feasibility of ZT adoption across sectors:

1. *Provide Actionable Federal Direction:* Public and private sectors need clearer pathways for ZT adoption. Federal entities, such as CISA, the National Security Agency (NSA), and the Office of the National Cyber Security Directorate (ONCD), should issue more detailed execution playbooks. Doing so would reduce the confusion highlighted previously: inconsistent pillars undermine implementation success.
2. *Promote Public-Private Collaboration:* Since threats are the same in both government and industry cyberspaces, policymakers should expand structured partnership channels to facilitate stronger ZT alignment. Shared vulnerability intelligence can improve incident response.
3. *Ensure Available Authority and Funding:* The government should ensure entities have sufficient influence and budget flexibility to modernize infrastructure and meet ZT conditions. In the same way, lawmakers should consider creating an “emergency fund” that organizations can rapidly access when unexpected issues arise during ZT administration.
4. *Rationalize Policy Structures:* ZT policies from agencies should be aligned with mission objectives to reduce unnecessary procedural complexity. Policymakers should also consider the use of reusable segmentation patterns and clearly communicate that isolating or restructuring legacy systems is a temporary but necessary inconvenience. Ultimately, these efforts will enable enterprises to modernize securely and realize the long-term benefits of ZT adoption. Simplification helps minimize misconfigurations.

5. *Adopt Phased Deployment:* Sectors should analyze phased implementation models to determine realistic migration costs and assess whether continued reliance on perimeter-based controls remains viable in today's threat landscape. A multi-stage strategy provides transparency, allowing entities to validate progress and refine capabilities before scaling modifications across the infrastructure.

IX. Conclusion: Critical Reflection

The Zero Trust (ZT) Cybersecurity Framework represents an essential advancement for strengthening national resilience in cyberspace, where threats are increasingly persistent, automated, and disruptive. By enforcing least-privilege controls, continuous verification, and rigorous authentication tools, ZT enhances the confidentiality, integrity, and provenance of sensitive information and assets across both public and private domains. As traditional perimeter-based approaches continue to fall short in addressing the widespread, impactful vulnerabilities, the ZT model offers a more adaptive and defensible focus capable of mitigating large-scale cyber risks.

The model's evolution depends on acknowledging and resolving its current constraints. Inconsistent patterns and misaligned technological foundations challenge ZT adoption. The recommendations outlined in this memo underscore the need for clearer guidance, stable funding mechanisms, phased schemes, and clarified policy structures that prioritize feasibility. With these strategic suggestions, the ZT application across federal and industrial ecosystems can progress to a more coherent national security posture.

Given the accelerating pace of cyber incidents, the urgency of adopting a mature ZT vision cannot be overstated. While it is not legally mandated, the aftermath of inaction, ranging from financial loss to reputational damage, is far too significant to ignore. The ZT framework is not just a technical investment or upgrade; it is a long-term commitment to safeguarding entities' interests. If executed with clarity and sustained political will, ZT can serve as the foundation for a more resilient, trustworthy, and secure digital nation.

Annotated Bibliography

American Council for Technology. 2019. "Zero Trust Cybersecurity Current Trends."

American Council for Technology-Industry Advisory Council. April 18.

<https://www.actiac.org/system/files/ACT-IAC Zero Trust Project Report 04182019.pdf>

This report, published by the American Council for Technology–Industry Advisory Council (ACT-IAC), a non-profit organization that promotes collaboration between the public and private sectors, analyzes current trends and the readiness of Zero Trust (ZT) cybersecurity within the U.S. federal landscape. The document offers a consensus-based assessment of ZT's maturity, adoption barriers, and applicability in modernizing systems. Furthermore, the study emphasizes that ZT represents an evolutionary framework that integrates security practices such as Identity, Credential, and Access Management (ICAM) and Software-Defined Networking (SDN). Likewise, the publication concludes that ZT offers substantial long-term security benefits but requires a coordinated, agency-wide effort, upfront investment, and integration of multiple vendor solutions. As a report developed jointly by government and industry experts, this source provides valuable insight into how federal agencies can gradually transition toward a ZT framework to enhance national cybersecurity resilience. Similarly, ACT-IAC's established reputation as a neutral and respected forum ensures that the resource's conclusions are balanced, authoritative, and grounded in practical, real-world expertise rather than political biases.

Department of Defense (DOD). 2022. "DoD Zero Trust Strategy." Portfolio Management

Office. November 7.

<https://dodcio.defense.gov/Portals/0/Documents/Library/DoD-ZTStrategy.pdf>

The official strategy was issued by the U.S. Department of Defense (DoD) Chief Information Officer (CIO), the principal advisor to the Secretary of Defense on all matters related to information technology, national cybersecurity, and defense business systems. The publication establishes a comprehensive plan to transition the Department's information enterprise toward a Zero Trust (ZT) architecture between 2023 and 2027. The text outlines an adaptive approach to securing the DoD Information Network (DODIN) and the Joint Information Environment (JIE) through principles such as least privilege access, micro-segmentation, and robust auditing. The document underscores that achieving ZT requires technical modernization and a fundamental cultural transformation across the defense ecosystem. This source is highly relevant for analyzing how federal institutions operationalize Zero Trust foundations into actionable policy frameworks within the broader context of U.S. national cybersecurity initiatives. As an authoritative report developed under federal cybersecurity mandates, it reflects the Department's leadership in strengthening national cyber resilience. The strategy serves as a clear model for policy-driven, enterprise-wide cybersecurity transformation within the public sector.

Dhiman, Poonam. 2024. "A Review and Comparative Analysis of Relevant Approaches of Zero Trust Network Model." *Sensors*. MDPI. February 19.

<https://doi.org/10.3390/s24041328>.

This article, authored by Poonam Dhiman from Government P.G. College, presents an extensive review of the Zero Trust (ZT) network model. The paper examines existing systems for ZTA adoption, focusing on authentication, encryption, and automation. Likewise, the researcher states that as conventional security frameworks become increasingly ineffective, ZT represents a necessary approach shift by promoting persistent verification and context-based security. Through a systematic taxonomy of ZT, the report compares traditional and ZT models, evaluating their core components and logical scheme. Additionally, the publication identifies key challenges such as scalability and user usability, while outlining future research directions to enhance implementation. By comparing existing methodologies, this source provides a well-rounded academic perspective on the current state and evolution of ZT adoption. Released in *Sensors* (MDPI), a peer-reviewed journal focusing on science and technology, this document serves as a valuable resource for policymakers and professionals seeking to deepen their understanding of ZT models and their role in advancing secure network architectures.

Dinolt, George. 2022. "Can You Trust Zero Trust?" *IEEE Xplore*. August 2.

<https://doi.org/10.1109/MC.2022.3178813>

This peer-reviewed article, authored by George C. Dinolt, a professor of practice in cyber operations at the Naval Postgraduate School's Department of Computer Science and Electrical Engineering, provides a critical evaluation of the Zero Trust (ZT) model. It argues that, despite ZT's growing popularity, the framework is conceptually inconsistent and practically infeasible to sustain in modern enterprises. The publication emphasizes that the absence of a unified trust model makes ZT more of a marketing term than a fully realizable standard. Drawing from NIST SP 800-207 and related studies, the paper highlights the challenges of applying ZT principles, including their incompatibility with legacy systems and the inherent need to trust system components. This critical source is valuable for understanding the controversies of ZT adoption, contrasting with technical views from industry reports. Published in *IEEE Xplore*, a leading scientific and technical research database from the Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE), the world's largest organization promoting technological innovation, this document's academic rigor, supported by contributions from cybersecurity experts such as Frederick B. Cohen, CEO of Management Analytics, and Duminda Wijesekera, Chair of the Cybersecurity Engineering Department at George Mason University, make it a reputable and reliable source for analyzing the practical and philosophical shortcomings of the ZT paradigm.

Fernandez, Eduardo. 2024. "A Critical Analysis of Zero Trust Architecture." *Computer Standards & Interfaces*. Science Direct. January 13.

<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.csi.2024.103832> .

This source, authored by Eduardo B. Fernandez, a scholar-practitioner from the College of Engineering and Computer Science at Florida Atlantic University, offers a systematic examination of Zero Trust Architecture (ZTA) through the lens of security theory. The purpose of the paper is to determine whether ZTA represents an ideal framework for building secure systems or if it falls to meet its stated expectations. Employing the structured method of security patterns, the publication assesses ZTA's conceptual soundness and applicability. In addition, the document critiques the tendency of industry publications to oversimplify the theoretical underpinnings of ZT, highlighting the scarcity of evidence and implementation reports. Finally, by decomposing ZTA into its architectural patterns, the researcher proposes a model that links ZT principles to underexplored areas such as performance, threats, and governance. Issued in *Computer Standards & Interfaces* by Elsevier's ScienceDirect, this intellectual text provides a rigorous, theory-based evaluation of ZTA, serving as an insightful resource for understanding the potential and limitations of ZT in enterprise security architecture.

Harding, Emily. 2025. "“Never Trust, Always Verify.”" Center for Strategic & International Studies (CSIS). <https://features.csis.org/zero-trust-architecture/> .

This report was authored by Emily Harding, Deputy Director and Senior Fellow with the Intelligence, National Security, and Technology (INT) Program at the Center for Strategic and International Studies (CSIS). Drawing on interviews with cybersecurity executives and federal agency officials, the text evaluates the feasibility and policy implications of large-scale Zero Trust Architecture (ZTA) adoption. It emphasizes that ZTA is an operational mindset centered on device awareness and adaptive access control across intricate government networks. Furthermore, the document identifies critical obstacles such as outdated infrastructure, fragmented leadership, and limited congressional funding. This source is significantly pertinent for analyzing real-world policy and organizational constraints shaping ZT strategies applied at the national level, including budgeting, workforce training, and interagency coordination. As a publication from CSIS, a bipartisan, nonprofit research institution specializing in foreign policy and national security, it provides a well-informed and trustworthy expertise. Moreover, its integration of expert insights from both the public and private sectors, along with actionable policy recommendations, makes it a valuable and balanced reference for examining Zero Trust implementation.

Kerr, Kevin. 2023. "Zero Trust: Public and Private Sectors Facing Similar Risks." TW.

Trustwave Holdings, Inc. August 24.

<https://www.trustwave.com/en-us/resources/blogs/trustwave-blog/zero-trust-public-and-private-sectors-facing-similar-risks/>.

This interview, authored by Kevin Kerr, lead security principal consultant at Trustwave and former Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) at Oak Ridge National Laboratory, presents a compelling comparative analysis of Zero Trust (ZT) applications across the state and corporate sectors. Drawing from his leadership experience in both environments, Kerr highlights that the impact of cyber threats varies significantly depending on each entity's mission and operational scope. The report outlines that ZT is a set of adaptive practices centered on data protection and collaboration between business and security teams. Also, Kerr underscores that effective ZT requires precise data categorization and strong partnerships to mitigate complexity in hybrid and cloud-based systems. This source is particularly valuable for understanding shared challenges and contextual differences organizations face when translating ZT principles into practice. It bridges the theoretical cybersecurity models with real-world adoptions, such as machine learning, multi-factor authentication, and remote work solutions. As a publication by Trustwave, a globally recognized cybersecurity company that fortifies entities against cyber risks, the interview carries high professional truthfulness and technical insight, making it a strong reference for examining the operational realities of ZT deployment across different environments.

"The Rise of Zero Trust." 2019. Engineering Simplicity. Juniper Networks, Inc. December.

<https://www.juniper.net/content/dam/www/assets/white-papers/us/en/security/the-rise-of-zero-trust.pdf>.

This white paper, published by Juniper Networks, a global leader in networking and cybersecurity solutions, separates myths from realities surrounding Zero Trust (ZT), defining it as a comprehensive security philosophy that eliminates implicit trust within networks. Also, this text argues that traditional perimeter-based strategies are insufficient against modern cyber challenges, promoting continuous verification, microsegmentation, and adaptive access control. Furthermore, the publication explains that ZT frameworks can be integrated through automation across physical and cloud environments. Likewise, the report stresses that ZT should be a core element of every organization's cybersecurity posture, regardless of size, industry, or maturity level. This resource offers a valuable business-oriented perspective, providing technical guidance that makes it a useful resource for examining how private sector innovation and policy-driven strategies foster the adoption of ZT principles. As a corporate document from a highly reputable multinational company, it delivers credible and informed insights into the practical operationalization of ZT within network architectures.

Rose, Scott. 2020. "Zero Trust Architecture." NIST Special Publication 800-207. August.

<https://doi.org/10.6028/NIST.SP.800-207>.

This document was developed by the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST), a U.S. Department of Commerce agency responsible for establishing information security standards. The publication defines the core principles of Zero Trust Architecture (ZTA) and outlines models and use cases for its implementation. Also, it introduces ZTA as a cybersecurity framework that eliminates implicit trust based on network location or device ownership, requiring continuous authentication and authorization of all entities. Moreover, the text provides a conceptual foundation for how public and private organizations can strengthen their overall technology security posture. This paper serves as a key source for understanding the foundational strategies that will inform the analysis of policy alignment in the United States, as well as application challenges related to network trends such as remote work, cloud computing, and personal devices. As an authoritative report issued under the Federal Information Security Modernization Act (FISMA) and the Office of Management and Budget (OMB) Circular A-130, NIST SP 800-207 stands as one of the most credible and widely recognized references in U.S. cybersecurity policy.

Shankar, Niranjana. 2025. "Zero Trust Must Be a Cybersecurity Priority for the Trump

Government." Infosecurity Magazine. February 19.

<https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/opinions/zero-trust-priority-trump/>.

This media article, authored by Niranjana Shankar, a software engineer specializing in cloud networking and security, argues that President Trump's incoming administration must prioritize Zero Trust Architecture (ZTA) as a central component of U.S. cybersecurity policy. The writer mentions the recent China-linked cyberattacks on U.S. federal agencies and underscores the persistence of systemic vulnerabilities despite previous federal cybersecurity initiatives. Moreover, the text emphasizes the progress achieved under the Office of Management and Budget (OMB) memorandum M-22-09, which outlines federal ZT strategies, while identifying ongoing obstacles, including outdated systems and organizational inertia. The source also advocates for enhanced inter-agency coordination and stronger public-private partnerships to accelerate nationwide adoption. Lastly, the article contrasts Trump's deregulatory approach with Biden's compliance-driven attitude, proposing measures to improve cyber resilience across public and private sectors. By assessing policy priorities across administrations, this page provides a helpful perspective on how political leadership shapes the application of ZT principles. Published in Infosecurity Magazine, a British media outlet specializing in cybersecurity, it offers valuable analysis of governance, technology, and national security in a changing digital landscape.